

Only **15%** of millionaires are in senior leadership positions in their companies, and only **7%** are C-suite executives.

Want to know what those regular jobs are? When we asked 10,000 millionaires what they did, the top three answers were engineer, accountant, and teacher. That last one blows my mind! Teachers are often notoriously underpaid, especially considering how hard they work and how important their jobs are. And yet, teaching is one of the most common professions among America's millionaires. That's awesome! Clearly, teachers know not only how to work hard but also know how to plan ahead with a long-term view. That's critical for future millionaires.

As for income, you may think all of these millionaire families earned six figures a year at a minimum—and that would make sense. Remember, 88% of them graduated from college, and education often leads to higher incomes. So, yeah, their salaries are a little higher than the national household average, and many of them did, in fact, break the six-figure ceiling. We found that 31% of millionaires had an average household income of \$100,000 or more a year over the course of their careers. If that's not where you are, though, don't worry. Take a close look at the numbers. If 31% *did* average \$100,000 in household income, that means 69% of millionaires—almost seven out of ten—*did not* average \$100,000 or more in household income per year. Plus, one-third of millionaires *never* had a six-figure household income in a single working year. Don't miss that. Many people working regular, blue-collar jobs fall for the myth that they need a high-paying job to build wealth, but don't buy the lie: a low salary won't disqualify you from millionaire status—if you use it wisely. Sure, salary is *a* factor in building wealth, but it isn't the *biggest* factor.